

# Jamaica has the students. We're building the room. Help us build the hackathon right.

Hack 876 is bringing about 80 Jamaican secondary-school students together for one day to build, ship and present something real.

We're not primarily looking for financial sponsorship. **We're looking for the things MLH knows how to do best.**

# From hacker to organizer.

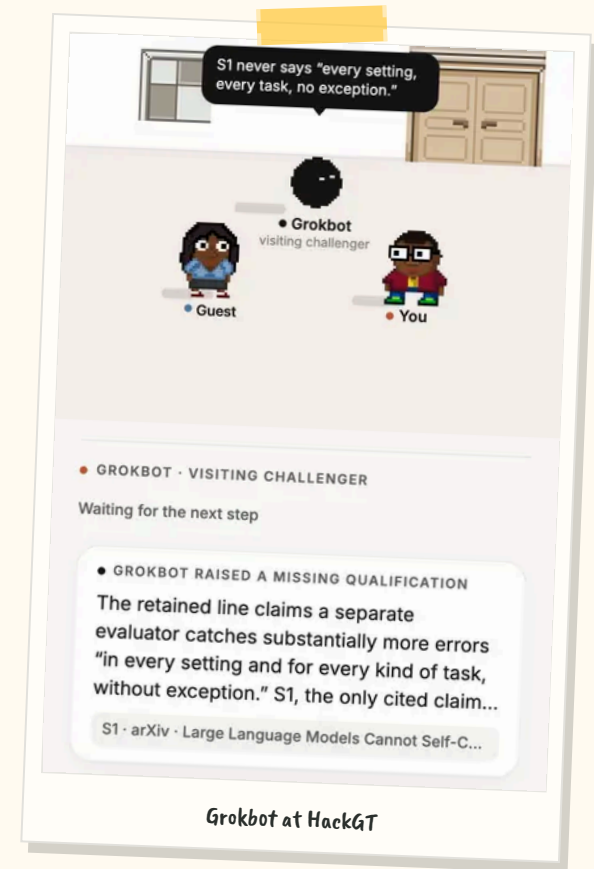
Mike, we met at HackGT while my teammate and I were building Thinketh. You spent some time with us, liked what we were building, and even snapped a photo of our Grokbot to share with the Grok team.

A few days later, I'm reaching out from the other side of the table.

**I'm helping build a hackathon.**

Hack 876 is the event I wish more Jamaican students could experience before university.

**Stefen**



## 02 THE EVENT

# One day. One room. Build something real.



Secondary-school students, mostly 5th Form through Upper 6th, in Kingston for one day: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).



## THE DAY

01

### Think

Find a real problem worth a day.

02

### Build

Turn it into a working prototype.

03

### Ship

Get it running. Imperfect is fine. Real is the rule.

04

### Present

Demo it. Explain the decisions.

## Not a talent gap. An exposure gap.

Jamaica already produces excellent engineers, designers and founders. Most of its secondary-school students will not meet a hackathon until university, if at all.

Hack 876 moves that first one earlier. It is not an AI hackathon. Teams build whatever the problem needs.

Web apps

Mobile apps

Games

Hardware

AI products

Education tools

Fintech

Civic tools

Design-led products

#### SCHOOLS WE'RE ALREADY TALKING WITH

■ Hillel Academy

■ Jamaica College

■ Wolmer's

■ American International School of Kingston

■ St. George's College

■ Campion College

■ Immaculate Conception High School

■ Ardenne High School

■ St. Andrew High School for Girls

Participation isn't limited to these schools.

# You already know what makes a hackathon feel real.

Hack 876 doesn't need another logo on the wall.

It would benefit from an organization that has spent years helping student hackathons build the right room for builders.

## IN ONE DAY, STUDENTS LEARN TO

Work as a team · Scope · Make tradeoffs · Build against a clock · Demo · Explain their decisions · Ship something imperfect but real

- Structure.
- Culture.
- Tools.
- Mentorship.
- **The little things hackers remember.**

> That's where we think MLH can matter.■

#### 04 THE BIGGEST ASK

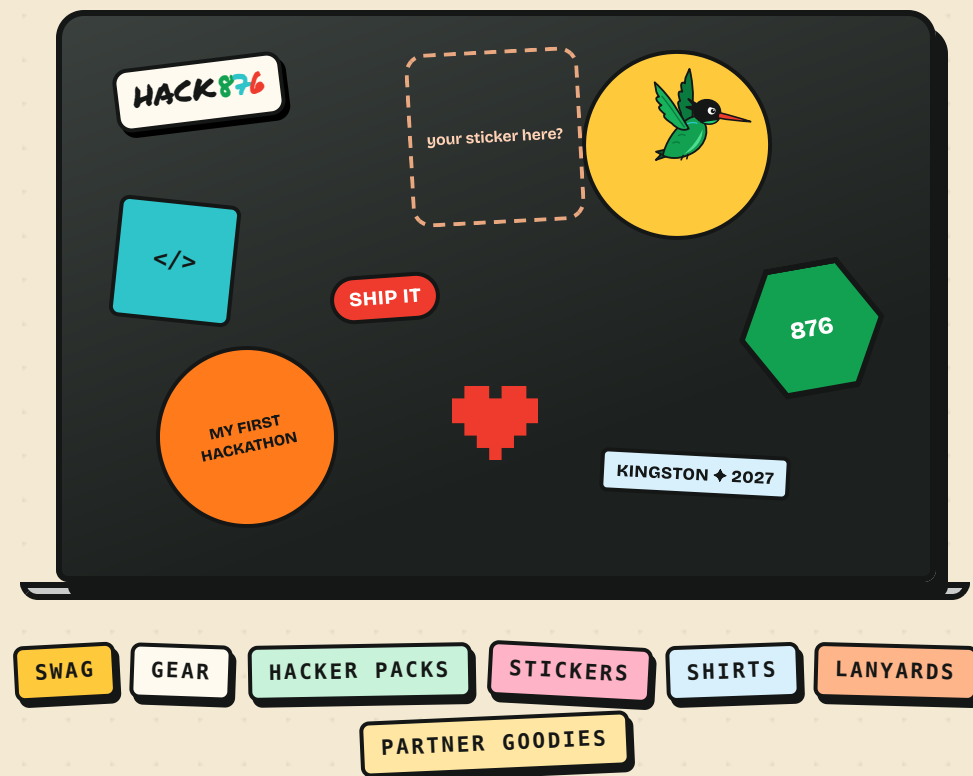
## Help us give them the hacker experience.

For many Hack 876 students, this will be their first hackathon. We want them to leave with more than a project.

The stickers on their laptop. The shirt they still wear months later. The lanyard in a drawer. The feeling that they joined a global builder community for a day.

**This is our biggest tangible ask from MLH.**

Not luxury prizes. Just the things that make it feel legit.



# We're doing the work. We'd love the experience.

## GUIDE

Share what works: judging, rules, code of conduct, submissions, team formation, demos, pacing and student safety.

## SHOW UP

Send a coach, mentor, judge or speaker. Remote or in person.

## CONNECT

Where it fits, help us reach the developer tools, credits and partner resources MLH brings into hackathons.

## AFFILIATE

Help us understand whether there is an MLH structure that fits a secondary-school hackathon in Jamaica.

**Not a funding ask.** Hack 876 is already in active conversations with Jamaican companies about financial support. We're coming to MLH for expertise, culture, resources and a connection to the wider hackathon community.



# Help us give 80 Jamaican students their first great hackathon.

If there's a way for MLH to be part of Hack 876, we'd love to figure out what that looks like.

Mike, if Jamaica sounds like a good place to judge a hackathon, the door is very open.

**Stefen O. Ewers Jr.**

Organizing Team, Hack 876

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JAMAICA · FEB 20, 2027 (TENTATIVE)

This is a proposal. Hack 876 is not currently sponsored by, affiliated with or endorsed by Major League Hacking.